

rekindle — Cascadia AI Hackathon Plan & Pitch

Theme: AI, Agents & MCP · 4 people · ~4 hrs each · + vibe-coding / AI tools Sponsor tools in use: AWS Amplify · Apify · Box · AWS

1. The idea

One-liner: Turn "let's hang out sometime" into a real plan. rekindle notices when you and someone you know could actually meet — then writes the message and suggests the when & where. You send it from the apps you already use.

The problem (real, not invented): People let relationships lapse not for lack of wanting to, but for lack of a *trigger* and the *words*. Personal-CRM apps (Clay, Dex) proved the pain is real — but they nudge on *time* ("it's been 3 months," easy to ignore). rekindle nudges on *opportunity* ("you're both in Lisbon Thursday" / "Dana's at Sunday's tennis meetup") — which is actionable.

The test we hold every feature to: does it start from something the user *already wants to do* (see a specific person, go to a thing, play a sport, visit a city)? If yes, it's a real need. If it invents the want (pairing strangers on inferred data), it's cut.

2. Two entry points, one engine

Two doors for two mindsets — people-first and event-first — feeding the same engine.

Door 1 — People. "I want to see Anne." Pick a person; the agent finds the opening (overlap, shared free time) and drafts the message + plan. Includes:

- **Shared-interest reconnection (hobby matching).** A filter on people you already know — "who that I know also plays tennis, and is around this weekend?" This is reconnecting over an activity, *not* matching strangers.
- **Visit Mode.** Heading to a city → flip Visit Mode → see which of your people (who also opted in) will be there.

Door 2 — Events. "Who from my circle is going to this?" An event from Luma / Eventbrite / Meetup, or a **public event discovered near you**, surfaced with the people you know who are attending — and a draft to coordinate going together.

The shared engine (both doors):

- A **message-first** card: the draft you'd send, up top; the "why" is proof underneath.
 - **Tone control**: warm / casual / brief.
 - A **suggested plan**: when you're both free + a spot near both of you.
 - A **low-pressure queue** you swipe at your own pace (right = open the draft, left = set aside), with an expiry timer so it never goes stale.
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3. After the send — we keep the plan, not a chat

Messages go out **through the apps people already use** (Instagram, Messages). We deliberately build **no chat**.

- **Why it's a strength**: the other person never has to download rekindle. We sidestep the network-effect trap that kills most social apps — value on day one, with people who aren't users.
 - **Plan pipeline, not a chat log**: one-tap **Sent** → **Plan set** → **Met** (runs on what *you* tell us; we never see replies).
 - **Follow-ups are just more drafting**: "they replied → lock it in" or "no reply → gentle nudge."
 - **Calendar handoff** turns "Plan set" into a real event.
 - **The metric is reconnections, not messages** — a visible counter, fed by a "Did you meet?" check-in.
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4. Relationship memory (the personal layer)

A quick voice/text note after you meet someone — *"met Anne at the hackathon, she's building an AI tutor for kids"* — so the next draft is personal, not generic ("...would love to hear how the AI tutor's coming along"). This is the second demo beat and the thing that makes the messages not feel robotic. Data is the **user's own notes** — nothing scraped.

5. Data — legitimate sources only

Principle: rekindle reads the user's *own* connected plans and surfaces *overlap* with people who also opted in. We never read or scrape anyone's social feed. Private social content (Instagram, LinkedIn connections) is off-limits to everyone, scraping included — so we don't build on it.

Source	What we get	How
Google Calendar	events, trips, free/busy	official API (user OAuth)
Luma	event details, guest lists, RSVPs	official API
Eventbrite	events + registrations	official API
Meetup	activity/hobby groups (the tennis case)	API / public listings
Apify	public event listings near you (discovery)	scrapes <i>public events</i> , not people
Relationship notes	the personal layer	user's own input
Instagram / LinkedIn	login + send only	OAuth sign-in; never a data source

On Apify (sponsor tool): its one job is **discovering public events** ("what's happening in your city this week"), which we then match against the people you know. In the demo we call this "*discovering public events*," not "*scraping*" — the distinction (public-event discovery vs. harvesting personal data) is exactly the judgment a judge is checking for.

6. Architecture (MCP-centric, on theme)

- **AWS Amplify** — the app backbone: Cognito (auth/sign-in), AppSync + DynamoDB (users, queue, plan pipeline, notes), hosting. This is how we "use Amplify" — no scraping involved.
 - **MCP server** (on AWS Lambda) exposing discoverable tools the agent reasons over: `get_calendar_overlap` · `get_event_guests` (Luma/Eventbrite/Meetup) · `discover_public_events` (Apify) · `generate_message` · `get_notes`
 - **The agent** decides *which* tools to call per situation (person door vs. event door) — that's the "agentic, not a fixed pipeline" story.
 - **Box** — stores the sent-message / reconnection log as exportable records (the "you own your history" angle).
 - Existing MCP servers (Google Calendar, Luma) can be leveraged for ingestion; the custom overlap + message-gen MCP is the team's secret sauce.
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7. Demo persona & the two beats

Maya — in Lisbon this week; based in Seattle.

- **Beat 1 (the crossing):** Maya opens the queue → top card: *"You're both in Lisbon — free Thursday. Here's a message."* → swipe → drafted note + a Thursday plan → handed off to Instagram. Or in Events mode: *"Sarah's going to the Tech Mixer Thursday — go together?"*
 - **Beat 2 (relationship memory):** Anne's card in New York reads *"...hear how the AI tutor for kids is coming along"* — because Maya noted it at the hackathon. The room sees the AI sound like Maya actually knows Anne.
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8. Critical feedback & how we answer it

- **"Agentic, or a recommendation engine with a chat wrapper?"** → The agent chooses which tools to call (calendar → event guests → discover → generate), per door.
 - **"Did you build real MCP?"** → Real MCP server on Lambda; we point at the tools.
 - **"Where does the data come from — are you scraping IG/LinkedIn?"** → No. Own calendar + official event APIs + *public* event discovery via Apify. IG/LinkedIn are login + send only. We say "discover public events," never "scrape people."
 - **"Won't this spam people?"** → No — the queue saves moments; at most a gentle nudge (Quiet mode available).
 - **"No chat?"** → On purpose. Send via apps people already use; the recipient never joins → no network-effect trap.
 - **"Does anyone actually meet?"** → Plan pipeline + follow-up drafts + the reconnection counter; we lower both the words barrier and the nerve barrier.
 - **"Hobby matching = a dating app?"** → No — it reconnects people you've *already met*, filtered by a shared activity. We never pair strangers.
 - **"What's mocked?"** → Volunteered up front: overlap logic, MCP, and message generation are real (Calendar wired live); other sources + send are seeded.
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9. SWOT

- **Strengths:** sharp focus; two coherent doors on one engine; on-theme MCP + Amplify build; emotionally resonant demo; opt-in/consent model that's simple by design; no chat = no network effect; legitimate data story.
- **Weaknesses:** value needs both people opted in (cold-start); we can't see replies, so the pipeline relies on user-updated status; non-Calendar sources seeded in this build.

- **Opportunities:** more event sources; richer relationship memory; group/community editions; friends-of-friends discovery (opted-in).
 - **Threats:** incumbents could add a feature; privacy expectations are high — visible trust is non-negotiable.
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10. Competitive edge (one line)

Personal CRMs nudge on time; travel-overlap apps only alert; Find My/Snap only show location; friend-dinner apps match strangers. **rekindle is the one that turns a real opportunity into a written message and a plan — for people you already know — and lets you act on your own terms.**

11. Build snapshot (full detail in the dev plan)

4 people × ~4 hrs. Two contracts frozen in the first 20 min (the card JSON + the MCP tool signatures) let everyone build in parallel against stubs, integrating only in the final 30 min. Wire **Google Calendar live**; seed Luma/Eventbrite/Meetup/Apify and the relationship-memory layer. Three scored screens: the two-door queue, the swipe deck, the drafted message + plan.